

Chris Pearce

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Santa Clara University — Media Services

Aug 2023 – Mar 2026

IT & AV Support Assistant · Santa Clara, CA

- Served as first-line technical support for faculty, staff, and students across 100+ classrooms, resolving **projector, display, audio-input, and connectivity issues** in person and over the phone.
- Maintained, reimaged, and provisioned checked-out **Windows and macOS** laptops and DSLR cameras, handling software updates, licensing, and version management, while balancing ~16 hrs/week (40 in summer) alongside full-time coursework.

PROJECTS

Consumer Application (Early Stage)

05/2026 – Current

Founding Engineer (Contract)

- Architected and built the **FastAPI** backend for an early-stage consumer app, implementing a **rules-based proposal engine** with **deterministic keyword routing** to automate group coordination and information sharing, plus a single-page frontend integrating four functional modules.
- Implemented backend integration points for a **layered AI safety system**, including **deterministic output filtering** and **asynchronous response review**.
- Self-hosted and served LLMs locally via **Ollama** and remotely via **vLLM** on **ThunderCompute**, comparing local vs. remote inference to power **document processing and translation**, a **tool-assisted chatbot**, and a **hierarchical multi-agent system**.
- Worked directly with the **product owner** from requirements through validation, owning backend scope and acceptance criteria on a compressed timeline.

Rice Strain CNN Classifier

01/2026 – 03/2026

University Project

- Built and evaluated **image classification** models (CNN and linear neural network) to identify 5 rice grain varieties using a 75,000-image dataset.
- Achieved ~97-98% accuracy on a **Convolutional Neural Network**.
- Implemented full ML pipeline including preprocessing (grayscale conversion, resizing, normalization), **model architecture design**, and training with **SGD** and **cross-entropy** loss.
- Developed an **object detection pipeline** using **OpenCV** (thresholding, contour detection, bounding boxes) to classify rice grains in real-world images.

SCU Marketplace Web App

09/2025 – 12/2025

University Project

- Developed a marketplace app where students can create, post, and browse listings for used items, similar to Facebook Marketplace.
- Users can create password-protected accounts containing contact information, location, and SCU ID verification.
- Frontend built using **Next.js**, providing dynamic page navigation that supports mobile layouts.
- Backend utilizes **Django** for **CRUD** operations on **SQLite** databases, **API routing**, and **request validation**.

SKILLS

Languages: C++, Java, Python, SQL

AI / ML: CNN, Computer Vision, Deep Learning, Image Processing, Neural Networks, NumPy, OpenCV, Pandas, PySpark, PyTorch, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Time Series Analysis

LLMs & Agentic Systems: Agentic AI, Google ADK, LLM Guardrails, LLMs, Multi-Agent Systems, Ollama, Prompt Engineering, RAG, RAG Agents, vLLM

Backend & Data: Data Pipelines (ETL), FastAPI, Node.js, PostgreSQL, REST APIs

Cloud & DevOps: CI/CD, Cloud Build, Cloud Run, Cloud Storage, Docker, ThunderCompute, Vertex AI

Frontend: Next.js, React

Tools: Git, Jupyter Notebook, Shell Scripting

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science

Emphasis in Data Science

Santa Clara University

09/2022 – 03/2026

Relevant coursework: Data Engineering, Data Science, Machine Learning